

Joshua Philip Suarez

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Research interests: Transport accessibility and equity; social dimensions of transport and land use; transport-related social exclusion; applied econometrics; quantitative social science

Education

National Taiwan University

2021 - 2023

Master of Science, Civil Engineering

- GPA: 4.27/4.30; Class rank: 1/24; Thesis grade: A+
- Thesis: "Transit-based Job Accessibility and Socio-spatial Inequities among Immigrants: A Multiscale Empirical Investigation in Taichung, Taiwan" ([Link](#))
- Advisors: Prof. S.K. Jason Chang, Prof. Jen-Jia Lin; Examiners: Prof. Chien-Hung Wei, Dr. Chao-Fu Yeh

University of the Philippines - Diliman

2013 - 2018

Bachelor of Science, Civil Engineering

Honors and awards

2024 Master's Thesis Award in Transportation Geography

04.2024

American Association of Geographers, Transportation Geography Specialty Group

Awarded annually to one outstanding Master's thesis in transportation geography. Prize: \$250. ([More details](#))

Best Paper Award for 'Enlightening Asia-Specific Topics'

09.2023

Eastern Asia Society for Transportation Studies

Awarded for academic and practical contribution to mobility research in the region. Prize: \$200. ([More details](#))

Graduate Students' Dean's Award

08.2023

National Taiwan University, College of Engineering

Awarded for outstanding scholastic achievement (89 out of ~1,000 graduate students). Prize: NTD 10,000. ([More details](#))

Phi Tau Phi Scholastic Honor Society - Honorary Membership

06.2023

Phi Tau Phi Scholastic Honor Society of the Republic of China

Awarded to the top 3% of Master's graduands in each university in Taiwan. ([More details](#))

Academic Achievement Award

05.2023

Ministry of Education, Taiwan (R.O.C.)

Awarded to outstanding Taiwan Scholarship recipients (20 out of 700+ graduates from 76 countries). ([More details](#))

Ministry of Education (MOE) Taiwan Scholarship

2021 - 2023

Ministry of Education, Taiwan (R.O.C.)

Government-funded scholarship for outstanding international students. Award: NTD 20,000/month.

TPLEX Award for Excellence in Transportation Engineering

06.2018

University of the Philippines - Diliman, Institute of Civil Engineering

Awarded for highest academic performance (1.00/1.00) in transportation engineering. Prize: PHP 5,000.

Republic Act No. 7687 Scholarship

2013 - 2018

Department of Science and Technology - Science Education Institute

National merit- and need-based scholarship for top-performing STEM undergraduates (top 5% of high school cohort).

Research experience

National Taiwan University

Research Assistant, Graduate Institute of Journalism

11.2025 - Present;

Projects: Global Perspectives on AI: Assessing Public Discourse, Opinion, and Big Tech's Role;

11.2023 - 04.2025;

The Influence of Technology on the Coupling of Science, Media, and Policies

01.2023 - 07.2023

- Collected, analyzed, and visualized large-scale social media data, co-authored several published and under-review works, and presented findings in an international conference

Work experience

CEST, Incorporated

Associate Transport Planner

01.2025 - 12.2025

Project: Davao City Comprehensive Transport and Traffic Master Plan

- Provided technical review of all reports, including pre-feasibility studies of priority projects

CTI Engineering International Co. Ltd.

Junior Engineer/Traffic Engineer

04.2020 - 11.2021

Project: Data Collection Survey on Urban Infrastructure Development in Greater Cotabato City

- Conducted analysis of socio-economic, public transport, and traffic data
- Prepared technical reports on the transport, port, and airport infrastructure sectors

Technical Assistant II

04.2019 - 03.2020

Project: The Study of Master Plan on High Standard Highway Network Development in the Philippines - Phase II

- Supported the nationwide traffic and logistics survey teams, and assisted with travel demand forecasting
- Analyzed data and prepared technical reports on the socio-economic and traffic situation along major highways

Peer-reviewed journal publications

* indicates corresponding author

- Suarez, J.P.* , Chang, S.K.J., & Lin, J.J. (2025). Exploring the nexus between transit-based job accessibility and labor market outcomes among marital immigrants. *Journal of Transport Geography*, 128, 104358. 2025
<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jtrangeo.2025.104358>
- Suarez, J.P., Sales, N.M., & Rauchfleisch, A.* (2025). Soft disempowerment dynamics in the 2022 FIFA World Cup. *Humanities and Social Sciences Communications*, 12 (1), 1772. <https://doi.org/10.1057/s41599-025-06062-6> 2025
- Rauchfleisch, A., Suarez, J.P., Sales, N.M., & Jungherr, A.* (2025). Winning and losing with Artificial Intelligence: What public discourse about ChatGPT tells us about how societies make sense of technological change. *Telematics and Informatics*, 103, 102344. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.tele.2025.102344> 2025
- Suarez, J.P.* , Lagonera, M.J., Ueno, R., & Sinarimbo, N. (2022). Examining Road Freight Transport Costs: A Philippine Perspective. *Journal of the Eastern Asia Society for Transportation Studies*, 14, 159–178. 2022
<https://doi.org/10.11175/easts.14.159>

Works in progress

* indicates corresponding author

Competitive transit-based job accessibility and socio-spatial inequalities following transit intervention with implications for marital immigrants

Suarez, J.P.* , Chang, S.K.J., Lin, J.J. (Status: Submitted, *Cities*)

The modifiable temporal unit problem in competitive accessibility metrics and downstream impacts on regression analyses

Suarez, J.P.* , Chang, S.K.J., Lin, J.J. (Status: For submission)

Academics' Social Media Engagement Predicts Policy Stringency and Mobility Dynamics during the COVID-19 Pandemic

Suarez, J.P., Sales, N.M., Rauchfleisch, A.* (Status: Under review, *Humanities and Social Sciences Communications*)

A Bayesian Maximum Entropy Approach to Assess Air Pollution Exposure along Cycling Routes

Suarez, J.P.* , Yu, H.L., Chang, S.K.J. (Status: In preparation)

Conference presentations

- Suarez, J.P., Sales, N.M., & Rauchfleisch, A. (2024). Global Sporting Events as Arenas of Soft Power and Soft Disempowerment: Insights from the 2022 FIFA World Cup Twitter Discourse. *The 74th Annual International Communication Association Conference*. Gold Coast, Australia. 06.2024
- Suarez, J.P., Yu, H.L., & Chang, S.K.J. (2023). A Bayesian Maximum Entropy Approach to Assess Air Pollution Exposure along Cycling Routes in Taipei, Taiwan. *The 15th International Conference of the Eastern Asia Society for Transportation Studies*. Shah Alam, Malaysia. 09.2023

Poster presentation

Javier, S., **Suarez, J.P.**, Ballarta, J., Napalang, M.S.G. (2019). Sustainable Public Transport for University Campus: Assessment of Public Utility Jeepney Routes inside the UP Diliman Campus. 09.2019
The 13th International Conference of the Eastern Asia Society for Transportation Studies. Colombo, Sri Lanka.

Skills

- **Programming** (R, Python, C, C++)
- **Statistics and Econometrics** (Stata, SPSS, Limdep, R)
- **Spatial Analysis, Visualization, and Mapping** (R *ggplot2*, Python *matplotlib*, QGIS)
- **Optimization** (Gurobi)
- **Social Network Analysis** (Gephi)

Relevant coursework

- **National Taiwan University:** Urban Transportation Planning, Traveler Behavior Analysis, Green Mobility and Sustainable Development, Population and Social Geography, Spatiotemporal Data Analysis and Mapping
- **University of the Philippines - Diliman:** Traffic Modelling and Simulation, Transportation Engineering

Professional affiliations

International Communication Association (ICA)	since 2024
American Association of Geographers (AAG)	since 2023
Eastern Asia Society for Transportation Studies (EASTS)	since 2019
Transportation Science Society of the Philippines (TSSP)	since 2019

Student affiliations and leadership experience

National Taiwan University Philippines Student Association Co-founding member	2022 - 2023
University of the Philippines Association of Civil Engineering Students President, 2017; Vice President for External Affairs, 2016	2014 - 2018
Philippine Institute of Civil Engineers, Inc. - UP Diliman Student Chapter Vice President for External Affairs, 2015-2016	2013 - 2018
Global Youth Leaders Travel and Learning Camp Awarded Best Speaker	08.2017

Languages

- **English** (Full professional proficiency; IELTS Academic: 8.0), **Filipino** (Native or bilingual proficiency), **Chinese** (Elementary proficiency)

References

S.K. Jason Chang, PhD • skchang@ntu.edu.tw

- Professor (Retired), Department of Civil Engineering, National Taiwan University
Prof. Chang was my professor and advisor during my Master's studies at NTU. He is my co-author on three manuscripts published or under review, as well as a co-author on a paper that received a Best Paper Award at the EASTS Conference 2023.

Jen-Jia Lin, PhD • jenjia@ntu.edu.tw

- Professor, Department of Geography, National Taiwan University
Prof. Lin was my co-advisor during my Master's studies at NTU. He is my co-author on three published or under-review works.

Adrian Rauchfleisch, PhD • adrian@ntu.edu.tw / adrian.rauchfleisch@gmail.com

- Professor, Graduate Institute of Journalism, National Taiwan University
Prof. Rauchfleisch is my current employer and co-author on three published or under-review works.